

A) Art and Craft in India

Art, Craft, Paintings, Music, Dance, Theatre, Puppetry, Circus, UNESCO - Cultural Heritages, Cinema, Martial Arts

1] The first Gandharva Mahavidyalaya, a music training school, was set up in 1901 by Vishnu Digambar Paluskar in: [2025]

- a) Delhi b) Gwalior
- c) Ujjain d) Lahore

2] Which one of the following was the latest inclusion in the Intangible Cultural Heritage List of UNESCO? [2024]

- a) Chhau dance b) Durga puja
- c) Garba dance d) Kumbh mela

3] Consider the following properties included in the World Heritage List released by UNESCO: [2024]

- 1. Shantiniketan
- 2. Rani-ki-Vav
- 3. Sacred Ensembles of the Hoysalas
- 4. Mahabodhi Temple Complex at Bodhgaya

How many of the above properties were included in 2023?

- a) Only one b) Only two
- c) Only three d) All four

4] Consider the following pairs: [2018]

- | Tradition | State |
|--------------------------|---------|
| 1. Chapchar Kut Festival | Mizoram |
| 2. Khongjom Parba ballad | Manipur |
| 3. Thang-Ta dance | Sikkim |

Which of the pairs given above is/are correct?

- a) 1 only b) 1 and 2
- c) 1 and 2 d) 2 and 3

5] The well-known painting “Bani Thani” belongs to the: [2018]

- a) Bundi School b) Jaipur School
- c) Kangra School d) Kishangarh School

6] With reference to cultural history of India, consider the following statements: [2018]

- 1. Most of the Tyagaraja Kritis are devotional songs in praise of Lord Krishna.
- 2. Tyagaraja created several new ragas
- 3. Annamacharya and Tyagaraja are contemporaries.
- 4. Annamacharya kirtnas are devotional songs in praise of Lord Venketshwara.

Which of the statement is given above are correct?

- a) 1 and 3 only b) 2 and 4 only
- c) 1, 2, and 3 d) 2, 3 and 4

7] Consider the following pairs: [2018]

- | Craft | Heritage of |
|-------------------------|-------------|
| 1. Puthukkuli Shawls | Tamil Nadu |
| 2. Sujni Embroidery | Maharashtra |
| 3. Uppada Jamdani Saris | Karnataka |

Which of the pairs given above is/are correct?

- a) 1 only b) 1 and 2
- c) 3 only d) 2 and 3

8] With reference to Manipuri Sankirtana, consider the following statements: [2017]

- 1. It is a song and dance performance.
- 2. Cymbals are the only musical instruments used in the performance.
- 3. It is performed to narrate the life and deeds of Lord Krishna.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- a) 1, 2 and 3 b) 1 and 3 only
- c) 2 and 3 only d) 1 only

9] Kalamkari painting refers to: [2015]

- a) A hand-painted cotton textile in South India
- b) A handmade drawing on bamboo handicrafts in North-East India
- c) A block-painted woollen cloth in Western Himalayan region of India
- d) A hand-painted decorative silk cloth in North-Western India

10] With reference to the famous Sattriya dance, consider the following statements: [2014]

1. Sattriya is a combination of music, dance and drama.
2. It is a centuries-old living tradition of Vaishnavites of Assam.
3. It is based on classical Ragas and Talas of devotional songs composed by Tulsidas, Kabir and Mirabai.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- a) 1 only b) 1 and 2 only
c) 2 and 3 only d) 1, 2 and 3.

11] With reference to India's culture and tradition, what is 'Kalaripayattu'? [2014]

- a) It is an ancient Bhakti cult of Shaivism still prevalent in some parts of South India.
b) It is an ancient style bronze and brasswork still found in southern part of Coromandel area.
c) It is an ancient form of dance-drama and a living tradition in the northern part of Malabar.
d) It is an ancient martial art and a living tradition in some parts of South India.

12] Consider the following pairs: [2014]

1. Garba: Gujarat
2. Mohiniattam: Odisha
3. Yakshagana: Karnataka

Which of the pairs given above is/are correctly matched?

- a) 1 only b) 2 and 3 only
c) 1 and 3 only d) 1, 2 and 3

13] Consider the following towns of India: [2014]

1. Bhadrachalam
2. Chanderi
3. Kancheepuram
4. Karnal

Which of the above are famous for the production of traditional sarees/fabric?

- a) 1 and 2 only b) 2 and 3 only
c) 1, 2 and 3 only d) 1, 3 and 4

14] In the context of cultural history of India, a pose in dance and dramatics called 'Tribhanga' has been a favourite of Indian artists from ancient times till today. Which one of the following statements best describes this pose? [2013]

- a) One leg is bent and the body is slightly but oppositely curved at waist and neck
b) Facial expressions, hand gestures and make-up are combined to symbolize certain epic or historic characters
c) Movements of body, face and hands are used to express oneself or to tell a story
d) A little smile, slightly curved waist and certain hand gestures are emphasized to express the feelings of love or eroticism

15] With reference to Dhrupad, one of the major traditions of India that has been kept alive for centuries, which of the following statements are correct? [2012]

1. Dhrupad originated and developed in the Rajput Kingdom period.
2. Dhrupad is primarily a devotional and spiritual music.
3. Dhrupad Alap uses Sanskrit syllables from Mantras
Select the correct answer using the codes below:
a) 1 & 2 Only b) 2 & 3 Only
c) 1, 2 & 3 Only d) None is correct

16] How do you distinguish between Kuchipudi and Bharatanatyam dances? [2012]

1. Dancers occasionally speaking dialogues is found in Kuchipudi dance but not in Bharatanatyam.
2. Dancing on the brass plate by keeping the feet on its edges is a feature of Bharatanatyam but Kuchipudi dance does not have such a form of movements.

Which of the statements given above is/are Correct?

- a) Only 1 b) Only 2
c) Both 1 & 2 d) Neither 1 nor 2

17] The brothers Umakant and Ramakant Gundecha are: [2009]

- a) Dhrupad vocalists b) Kathak dancers
c) Sarod Maestros d) Tabla players

18] Consider the following famous name: [2009]

- | | |
|--------------------|-------------------------|
| 1. Amrita Sher-Gil | 2. Bikash Bhattaeharjee |
| 3. N. S. Bendre | 4. Subodh Gupta |

Who of the above is/are well known as artist (s)?

- | | |
|--------------------|------------------|
| a) 1 only | b) 1 and 4 only |
| c) 2, 3 and 4 only | d) 1, 2, 3 and 4 |

19] Consider the following statements: [2009]

1. The National School of Drama was set up by Sangeet Natak akademi in 1959.

2. The highest honour conferred by the Sahitya akademi on a writer is by electing him its Fellow.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- | | |
|-----------------|--------------------|
| a) 1 only | b) 2 only |
| c) Both 1 and 2 | d) Neither 1 nor 2 |

20] Match List I with List II and select the correct answer using the code given below the lists: [2009]

List-I (Famous Person)-

List-II (Well-known for)

- | | |
|-----------------------------|--|
| A. Mandakini Amte | 1. Theatre direction |
| B. Neelam Mansingh Chowdhry | 2. Social Service and Community leadership |
| C. Romila Thaper | 3. Dance |
| D. Vanashree Rao | 4. History writing |

- | | | | |
|------|---|---|---|
| A | B | C | D |
| a) 2 | 1 | 4 | 3 |
| b) 2 | 4 | 1 | 3 |
| c) 3 | 1 | 4 | 2 |
| d) 3 | 4 | 1 | 2 |

21] Consider the following pairs: [2009]

Tradition: State

1. Gatka, a traditional martial art:

Kerala

2. Madhubani, a traditional painting: **Bihar**

3. Singhey Khababs Sindhu Darshan Festival: **Jammu Kashmir**

Which of the pairs given above is/are correctly matched?

- | | |
|-----------------|---------------|
| a) 1 and 2 only | b) 3 only |
| c) 2 and 3 only | d) 1, 2 and 3 |

22] Match List I with List II and select the correct answer using the code given below the lists: [2009]

(Famous person)

(Well-known as)

- | | |
|------------------------------|------------|
| a) Amrita Sher-Gil | 1. Dancer |
| b) Bhimsen Joshi | 2. Painter |
| c) Rukmini Devi Arundale | 3. Poet |
| d) Suryakant Tripathi Nirala | 4. Singer |

- | | | | |
|------|---|---|---|
| A | B | C | D |
| a) 2 | 1 | 4 | 3 |
| b) 2 | 4 | 1 | 3 |
| c) 3 | 1 | 4 | 2 |
| d) 3 | 4 | 1 | 2 |

23] Bimbavati Devi is a well-known dancer of which type of dance? [2008]

- | | |
|--------------|------------------|
| a) Manipuri | b) Bharat Natyam |
| c) Kuchipudi | d) Odissi |

24] Match List-I with List-II and select the correct answer using the code given below the lists: [2007]

List-I (Person)

List-II (known as)

- | | |
|------------------------|------------------------|
| A. Bhajan Sopori | 1. Bharatnatyam dancer |
| B. Birju Maharaj | 2. Exponent of Santoor |
| C. Priyadarsini Govind | 3. Mridangam maestro |
| D. T.V. Gopalakrishnan | 4. Kathak dancer |

- | | | | |
|------|---|---|---|
| A | B | C | D |
| a) 2 | 1 | 4 | 3 |
| b) 3 | 1 | 4 | 2 |
| c) 2 | 4 | 1 | 3 |
| d) 3 | 4 | 1 | 2 |

25] Match List I with List II and select the correct answer using the code given below the lists: [2006]

Centre of Handicrafts (State)

- | | |
|-------------|----------------------|
| A. Mon | 1. Arunachal Pradesh |
| B. Nalbari | 2. Assam |
| C. Pasighat | 3. Meghalaya |
| D. Tura | 4. Nagaland |

- | | | | |
|------|---|---|---|
| A | B | C | D |
| a) 4 | 2 | 1 | 3 |
| b) 4 | 3 | 2 | 1 |
| c) 1 | 3 | 4 | 2 |
| d) 1 | 2 | 4 | 3 |

26] Who among the following is a Hindustani classical singer? [2006]

- a) Geeta Chandran b) Leela Samson
- c) Gangubai Hangal d) Swapnasundari

27] Who among the following was presented with the Sangeet Natak Akadami Ratna Award, 2005 for her lifetime achievement in dance? [2006]

- a) Chandrlekha b) Tanjavur Balasaraswati
- c) Uma Sharma d) Yamini Krishnamurthy

28] Who among the following is well known as an exponent of flute? [2004]

- a) Debu Choudhuri b) Madhup Mudgal
- c) Ronu Mazumdar d) Shafaat Ahmad

29] The Raga which is sung early in the morning is: [2000]

- a) Todi b) Darbari
- c) Bhopali d) Bhimpalasi

30] Consider the following statements regarding the Chakiarkoothu form of dance: [2000]

- I. It is performed by Chakiar caste.
- II. It cannot be traditionally witnessed by the higher caste Hindus.
- III. Mizhavu is the accompanying instrument.
- IV. Its theatre form is called koothambalam.

Which of these statements are correct?

- a) I, III and IV b) I, II and III

c) II, III and IV

d) I, II and IV

31] The paintings of Abanindranath Tagore are classified as: [1999]

- a) Realistic b) Socialistic
- c) Revivalistic d) Impressionistic

32] Which one of the following pairs of folk-dance forms and states is not correctly matched? [1999]

- a) Korku: Maharashtra
- b) Jhummar: Haryana
- c) Thali: Himachal Pradesh
- d) Mukna: Manipur

33] Which one of the following dances involves solo performance? [1997]

- a) Bharatanatyam b) Kuchipudi
- c) Mohiniattam d) Odissi

34] Which one of the following pairs is correctly matched? [1996]

- a) Naqqal – Bihar b) Tamasha- Orissa
- c) Ankia Nat – Assam d) Baha – Punjab

35] The Mughal School of Painting formed the spinal column of the various schools of Indian miniature art. Which one of the following painting styles was not affected by Mughal painting? [1995]

- a) Pahari b) Rajasthani
- c) Kangra d) Kalighata

B) Indian Culture and Heritage

Indian Culture, Cultural Institutions, Cultural and Scientific Heritage, Languages, National Symbols, Awards, Various Tribes and Communities, Festivals

1] Who amongst the following are members of the Jury to select the recipient of 'Gandhi Peace Prize'? [2025]

- I. The President of India
 - II. The Prime Minister of India
 - III. The Chief Justice of India
 - IV. The Leader of Opposition in the Lok Sabha
- Select the correct answer using the code given below.

- a) II and IV only b) I, II and III
- c) II, III and IV d) I and III only

2] With reference to India, the terms 'Halbi Ho' and 'Kui' pertain to [2021]

- a) Dance forms of Northwest India
- b) Musical instruments
- c) Pre-historic cave paintings
- d) Tribal languages

3] Consider the following statements in respect of Bharat Ratna and Padma Awards: [2021]

- 1) Bharat Ratna and Padma Awards are titles under the Article 18(1) of the Constitution of India.
- 2) Padma Awards, which were instituted in the year 1954, were suspended only once.
- 3) The number of Bharat Ratna Awards is restricted to a maximum of five in a particular year.

Which of the above statements are not correct?

- a) 1 and 2 only b) 2 and 3 only
- c) 1 and 3 only d) 1, 2 and 3

4] Consider the following statements: [2021]

- 1) 21st February is declared to be the International Mother Language Day by UNICEF.
- 2) The demand that Bangla has to be one of the national languages was raised in the Constituent Assembly of Pakistan.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- a) 1 only b) 2 only
- c) Both 1 and 2 d) Neither 1 nor 2

5] Consider the following pairs: [2017]

Traditions

Communities

- 1. Chaliha Sahib Festival — Sindhis
- 2. Nanda Raj Jaat Yatra — Gonds
- 3. Wari-Warkari — Santhals

Which of the pairs given above is/are correctly matched?

- a) 1 only b) 2 & 3 only
- c) 1 & 3 only d) None of the above

6] Every year, a month-long ecologically important campaign/festival is held during which certain communities/tribes plant samplings of fruit-bearing trees. Which of the following are such communities/tribes? [2014]

- a) Bhutia and Lepcha b) Gond and Korku
- c) Irula and Toda d) Sahariya and Agariya

7] With reference to the 'Changpa' community of India, consider the following statements: [2014]

- 1. They live mainly in the State of Uttarakhand
- 2. They rear the Pashmina goats that yield a fine wool.
- 3. They are kept in the category of Scheduled Tribes.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- a) 1 only b) 2 and 3 only
- c) 3 only d) 1, 2 and 3

8] Chaitra 1 of the national calendar based on the Saka Era corresponds to which one of the following dates of the Gregorian calendar in a normal year of 365 days? [2014]

- a) 22nd March (or 21st March)
- b) 15th May (or 16th May)
- c) 21st March (or 30th March)
- d) 21st April (or 20th April)

9] A community of people called Manganiyars is well-known for their: [2014]

- a) Martial arts in North-East India
- b) Musical tradition in North-West India.
- c) Classical vocal music in South India.
- d) Pictorial tradition in Central India.

10] With reference to the Bombay Natural History Society (BNHS), consider the following statements: [2014]

- 1. It is an autonomous organization under the Ministry of Environment and Forests.
- 2. It strives to conserve nature through action-based research, education and public awareness.
- 3. It organizes and conducts nature trails and camps for the general public.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- a) 1 and 3 only
- b) 2 only
- c) 2 and 3 only
- d) 1, 2 and 3

11] Consider the following languages: [2014]

- 1. Gujarati
- 2. Kannada
- 3. Telugu

Which of the above has/have been declared as 'Classical Language/Languages' by the Government?

- a) 1 and 2 only
- b) 3 only
- c) 2 and 3 only
- d) 1, 2 and 3

12] The national motto of India, 'Satyameva Jayate' inscribed below the Emblem of India is taken from: [2014]

- a) Katha Upanishad
- b) Chandogya Upanishad
- c) Aitareya Upanishad
- d) Mundaka Upanishad

13] Consider the following pairs: [2013]

- | Tribes: | State |
|-------------------|------------------|
| 1. Limbo (Limbu): | Sikkim |
| 2. Karbi: | Himachal Pradesh |
| 3. Dongria Kondh: | Odisha |
| 4. Bonda: | Tamil Nadu |

Which of the above pairs are correctly matched?

- a) 1 and 3 only
- b) 2 and 4 only
- c) 1, 3 and 4 only
- d) 1, 2, 3 and 4

14] With reference to the scientific progress of ancient India, which of the statements given below are correct? [2012]

- 1. Different kinds of specialised surgical instruments were in common use by the 1st century AD.
- 2. Transplant of internal organs in the human body had begun by the beginning of 3rd century AD.
- 3. The concept of sine of an angle was known in 5th century AD.
- 4. The concept of cyclic quadrilaterals was known in the 7th century AD.

Select the correct answer using the codes given below:

- a) 1 and 2 only
- b) 3 and 4 only
- c) 1, 3 & 4 only
- d) 1, 2, 3, 4

15] Among the following, who are the Agaria community? [2009]

- a) Traditional toddy tappers community of Andhra Pradesh
- b) Traditional fishing community of Maharashtra
- c) Traditional silk-weaving community of Karnataka
- d) Traditional salt pan workers community of Gujarat

16] In which one of the following places is the Shompen tribe found? [2009]

- a) Nilgiri Hills
- b) Nicobar Islands
- c) Spiti Valley
- d) Lakshadweep Islands

17] What does Baudhayan theorem (Baudhayan Sulva Sutra) related to? [2008]

- a) Lengths of sides of a right-angled triangle
- b) Calculation of the value of pi
- c) Logarithmic calculations
- d) Normal distribution curve

18] Among the Indian languages, which one is spoken maximum in the world after Hindi? [2008]

- a) Telugu
- b) Tamil
- c) Bengali
- d) Malayalam

19] What is the number of spokes in the Dharma chakra in the National Flag of India? [2008]

- a) 16
- b) 18
- c) 22
- d) 24

20] Indian Airlines (new name: Indian) have redesigned their logo, which is a graphic wheel. This logo has been inspired by which one of the following? [2006]

- a) Hampi Temples
- b) Mamallapuram Temples
- c) Sun Temple, Konark
- d) Khajuraho Temple

21] Match List I with List II and select the correct answer using the code given below the lists: [2006]

List. I
(Finding / Invention/ Calculation) List. II
(Ancient Indian Scholar)

- | | |
|---|-------------------|
| A. Time Taken by the Earth to orbit the Sun | 1. Aryabhatta |
| B. Calculation of the value of pi | 2. Bhaskaracharya |
| C. Invention of the digit zero | 3. Budhayana |
| D. The game of snakes and ladders | 4. Gyandev |

- | A | B | C | D |
|------|---|---|---|
| a) 2 | 4 | 1 | 3 |
| b) 2 | 3 | 1 | 4 |
| c) 1 | 3 | 2 | 4 |
| d) 1 | 4 | 2 | 3 |

22] Which of the following is not correctly matched? [2006]

- | Prominent Writer | Indian Language |
|------------------------------|-----------------|
| a) Raja Rao: | Telugu |
| b) Gobind Trimbuk Deshpande: | Marathi |
| c) Subramaniam Bharati: | Tamil |
| d) Tara Shankar Joshi: | Gujarati |

23] In which one of the following union territories do the people of the Onge tribe live? [2004]

- a) Andaman and Nicobar Islands
- b) Dadra and Nagar Haveli
- c) Daman and Diu
- d) Lakshadweep

24] Which one of the following statements is incorrect? [2003]

- a) The National Song Vande Mataram was composed by Bankimchandra Chatterji originally in Bengali
- b) The National Calendar of India based on Saka era has its 1st Chaitra on 22nd March normally and 21st March in a leap year
- c) The design of the National Flag of India was adopted by the Constituent Assembly on 22nd July 1947
- d) The song 'Jana Gana Mana', composed originally in Bengali by Rabindranath Tagore was adopted in its Hindi version by the Constituent Assembly on 24th January 1950 as the National Anthem of India

25] Chapchar Kut is a festival celebrated in the state of: [2002]

- | | |
|----------------------|-----------|
| a) Arunachal Pradesh | b) Assam |
| c) Mizoram | d) Sikkim |

26] Which one of the following pairs of primitive tribes and places of their inhabitation is not correctly matched. [2000]

- | | |
|-----------|--------------|
| a) Buksa: | PauriGarhwal |
| b) Kol: | Jabalpur |
| c) Munda: | Chhotanagpur |
| d) Korba: | Kodagu |

27] Which one of the following languages belongs to the Austric group? [1998]

- | | |
|------------|------------|
| a) Marathi | b) Ladakhi |
| c) Khasi | d) Tamil |

28] The Badami rock inscription of Pulakesin I is dated in the Saka year 465. If the same were to be dated in Vikrama Samvat, the year would be: [1997]

- | | | | |
|--------|--------|--------|--------|
| a) 601 | b) 300 | c) 330 | d) 407 |
|--------|--------|--------|--------|

29] Match List I with List II and select the correct answer by using the codes given below the lists: [1996]

- | List I | List II |
|------------------|--------------|
| I. Visakhadatta | A) Medicine |
| II. Varahamihira | B) Drama |
| III. Charaka | C) Astronomy |

IV. Brahmagupta

D) Mathematics

a) I A, II C, III D, IV B

b) I B, II A, III C, IV D

c) I B, II C, III A, IV D

d) I C, II B, III A, IV B

30] Match List I with List II and select the correct answer by using the codes given below the lists. [1995]

List I (Eras) List II (Reckoned from)

I. Vikrama era A) 3102 B.C.

II. Saka era B) 320 A.D.

III. Gupta era C) 78 A.D.

IV. Kali era D) 58 B.C.

E) 248 A.D.

a) IB, IID, IIIE, IVA

b) IA, IIC, IIIB, IVD

c) ID, IIE, IIIB, IVC

d) ID, IIC, IIIB, IVA

31] Zero was invented by: [1995]

a) Aryabhata b) Varahamihira

c) Bhaskara I d) An unknown Indian